

Ἀριστοκλῆς ὁ Μεσσηνίος

Aristotelian Wisdom in the Fragments of Aristocles of Messene

eul_aid: lfo

Period: Ἑλληνιστική Hellenistic
Dialect: Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική Attic Philosophical
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Πραγματεία Treatise
Affiliation: Peripatetic

Aristocles of Messene was a philosopher of the Peripatetic school, which followed the tradition of Aristotle. His exact identity and dates are uncertain. While sometimes placed in the 4th century BCE, most modern scholars believe he was active in the 1st century CE. This later dating is based on his detailed critiques of post-Aristotelian philosophies like Skepticism and Epicureanism.

He is best known as the teacher of Alexander of Aegae, who later instructed the Roman emperor Nero. His only known work is **On Philosophy**, a large-scale critical history of philosophy that survives only in fragments quoted by later authors like Eusebius of Caesarea. According to scholars, this work was organized into at least ten books and provided summaries and refutations of doctrines from the Pre-Socratics to his own time.

Aristocles's primary significance lies in these fragments, which preserve valuable information about other philosophers. His summaries are particularly important for understanding early Pyrrhonian Skepticism, as he provides one of the key surviving accounts of the thinker Pyrrho. Academics view his work as an important example of Peripatetic engagement with and criticism of other Hellenistic schools during the early Roman Imperial period.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Σοφίας · Fragments on the Nature of Wisdom · 27 passages

Other Peripatetic Authors

- Ἀγαθαρχίδης ὁ Κνίδιος · Agatharchides of Cnidus · 4 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Alexander of Aphrodisias II · 2 works
- Ἀνδρόνικος ὁ Ῥόδιος · Andronicus of Rhodes · 2 works
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · Aristo of Ceos · 1 work
- Ἀριστόβουλος ὁ Ἰουδαῖος · Aristobulus the Jewish Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἀριστόμβροτος ὁ φιλόσοφος · Aristombrotus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · Ariston of Ceos · 1 work
- Ἀσπάσιος ὁ Περιπατητικός · Aspasius the Peripatetic · 1 work
- Βοηθὸς ὁ Σιδώνιος · Boethus of Sidon · 1 work

- [Χαμαιλέων ὁ Ἡρακλεώτης · Chamaeleon of Heraclea Pontica](#) · 2 works
- [Κλέαρχος ὁ Σολεύς · Clearchus of Soli](#) · 1 work
- [Κριτόλαος ὁ Φασηλίτης · Critolaus of Phaselis philosopher](#) · 1 work